

Aparna Dhiraj — Portfolio Design Spec (for Figma)

A single-page scrolling portfolio with a warm, "paper & ink" Japanese-inspired editorial feel. Below is everything you need to rebuild it as static frames in Figma.

1. Design Tokens

Colors

Name	Hex / Value	Used for
Paper (bg)	#F6F1E7	Main background
Paper Dim	#EDE6D6	Alternate section background (Works, Contact)
Card	#FFFDF8	Cards, modals, inputs
Ink (text)	#232839	Headings, primary text
Ink Soft	#5B5F72	Body/secondary text
Road / Road Dark	#FF6B4A / #E24E30	Accent — eyebrow labels, CTA hover, primary accent dot
Teal	#1F9A93	Accent — photo gradient, one timeline dot
Gold	#F2A93B	Accent — quote border, tape strips, one timeline dot
Berry	#E8456B	Accent — one timeline dot, tape strip
Sky	#3577C9	Accent — photo gradient, one timeline dot
Line	rgba(35,40,57,0.12)	Borders, dividers
Shadow	0 20px 55px rgba(35,40,57,0.16)	Soft elevation on cards/photo

Typography

Three font families, used consistently for distinct roles:

- Shippori Mincho** (serif, weights 400/500/600/800) — all headings (

h1/h2/h3

), italic quotes, timeline role labels. Gives the editorial/Japanese feel.
- Zen Kaku Gothic New** (sans, 300/400/500/700) — default body copy everywhere.

3. **JetBrains Mono** (monospace, 400/500) — all-caps "eyebrow" labels, tags, dates, nav-style micro text. Always uppercase, letter-spacing ~0.1-0.2em.

Type scale:

- Landing hero "こんにちは": $\text{clamp}(3.5\text{rem}, 12\text{vw}, 8\text{rem})$, weight 600
- Section H2: $\text{clamp}(2\text{rem}, 4.5\text{vw}, 2.8\text{rem})$, serif
- Profile H1 (name): $\text{clamp}(2.2\text{rem}, 5\text{vw}, 3.2\text{rem})$, weight 600
- Eyebrow label: 0.72rem , mono, uppercase, 0.18em tracking, color Road Dark
- Body copy: $0.95-1\text{rem}$, line-height 1.7-1.85, color Ink Soft

Spacing / Shape language

- Sections use generous vertical padding: ~7rem top/bottom on desktop.
 - Cards and modals are **not** perfectly rectangular — modal edges use a subtle torn-paper zigzag (irregular clip-path on top/bottom edges).
 - A small strip of "washi tape" (semi-transparent gold/berry rectangle, rotated 3-9°) decorates the top of modals and the photo frame corners — a recurring scrapbook motif.
 - Buttons and cards are square-cornered (no big border-radius) except circular elements (photo accents, timeline dots).
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2. Page Flow (top to bottom)

A. Landing (full-screen intro)

- Full viewport height, centered content, soft radial-gradient blobs (orange + teal) on the paper background.
- Large Japanese greeting "こんにちは" with "KONICHIWA" small-caps mono label underneath.
- Italic serif quote below (max-width ~34rem).
- A dark pill/rectangle button: small circular "hanko" stamp icon (looks like a Japanese name seal — a circle with a concentric ring and a kanji character) + "Aparna Dhiraj" text. This is the "enter" CTA.
- A scroll-hint at the very bottom: small vertical line with a pulsing fade animation + "meet aparna" label. Clicking anywhere triggers transition to the Profile section (fades/slides landing out).

B. Profile (full-screen, revealed after landing)

- Two-column layout (stacks on mobile): photo left, text right, centered as a group.

- **Photo:** square (not circle) polaroid/scrapbook-style photo — gradient fill (teal→sky) with initials "AD", rotated slightly (-3°), thick cream border that's noticeably thicker on the bottom edge (polaroid caption strip look), two small tape strips at opposite corners (gold top-left, berry bottom-right), drop shadow. On hover it straightens and scales up slightly; a small "view about →" mono label fades in beneath it (it's clickable — opens the About modal).
- **Text block:** eyebrow ("Software Engineering Student") → Name (H1) → role line in mono/caps → italic pull-quote with a gold left border → a short paragraph bio.

C. About Modal (triggered by clicking the photo)

- Centered overlay, dark translucent backdrop with blur.
- Torn-paper card (see shape language above) with a tape strip at the top.
- Content: eyebrow "About Aparna" → H2 "More than the résumé" → 3 short paragraphs of bio detail → a row of skill tags (pill-shaped mono chips: Ollama, Node.js, MongoDB, Agile/Scrum, Prompt Engineering, 4 Languages).
- Close button (×) top-right corner.

D. Works (section, alternate background)

- Section header: just "Works" (H2), centered.
- **Layout: one continuous auto-sliding horizontal carousel** (not grouped/categorized — all ~11 work items in a single flowing strip). Cards drift left continuously and loop seamlessly; motion pauses on hover so it's readable. Edges of the strip fade out (mask gradient) so cards appear to emerge/disappear at the sides rather than cutting off abruptly.
- Each card: mono "tag" label (e.g. "Granted Patent", "HackRx 6.0 · Semi-finalist") → serif title → short description. Clicking a card opens a Project modal.
- **Project modal:** same torn-paper modal style, with a placeholder video/media block at the top (16:9, dark), then tag, title, description, and a "view on GitHub" link.

E. Work Experience (section)

- Section header: eyebrow "The Journey" + H2 "Work Experience".
- **Concept only — layout is flexible, feel free to design your own take in Figma.** The current build uses a single thin hand-drawn-style curving line winding down the page connecting 5 colored circular markers (one per role), each labeled with role + organization; clicking a marker opens a detail modal with dates and a longer description. Treat this as a reference for the *idea* (a journey/timeline metaphor with personality, not a plain list) — not a pixel spec to copy. A conventional vertical timeline, a horizontal scroller, or your own illustrated path would all fit the site's tone equally well.
- **Experience detail modal:** same torn-paper style, shows eyebrow (dates), H2 (title), mono line (organization), paragraph (detail).

- Data for reference (5 roles, chronological):
 1. Frontend Developer Intern — Climentos — Nov-Dec 2024
 2. Project Management Intern — LimeUp — May-Jun 2025
 3. Frontend Developer — Averixis Solutions — Aug-Oct 2025
 4. Campus Ambassador — Unstop — Aug-Nov 2025
 5. Machine Learning Intern — CSIR-IICT — Jun 2026-Present

F. Contact & Guestbook (section, alternate background)

- Section header: eyebrow "Let's Talk" + H2 "Contact & Guestbook".
- A row of 3 mono text links (email, phone, LinkedIn), centered, underlined on hover.
- **Guestbook:** a simple form (name input, message textarea, dark submit button "Sign the guestbook") followed by a list of previously submitted notes (name + date in mono/accent color, message below in body text). Empty state: italic "No notes yet — be the first to say hello."

G. Footer

- Centered, small mono caps text: "Handcrafted by Aparna Dhiraj · 陸 · [year]"
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3. Recurring Components to build once, reuse everywhere

1. **Eyebrow label** — mono, uppercase, letter-spaced, Road Dark color. Used above nearly every heading.
 2. **Torn-paper modal** — Card-colored box, irregular jagged top/bottom edge, tape strip decoration at top-center, close (X) button top-right, soft layered shadow, slight rotation.
 3. **Tag chip** — pill-shaped outline, mono text, used for skills and work-card labels.
 4. **Work card** — rectangular card, mono tag → serif title → soft body description, subtle lift shadow on hover.
 5. **Colored role dot** — circle, solid accent color, emoji/icon centered, white ring gap against the page background — used in the Experience section.
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4. Responsive notes

- Below ~640px: profile columns stack vertically; timeline markers/labels shrink; general padding tightens.
 - Reduced-motion preference: all animations/transitions should be near-instant (accessibility).
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This spec describes the current live build. Feel free to deviate on layout details (especially the Experience section) — the sketch you shared was just a mood reference, not a literal spec.